VICTORY 2026

HISTORY

QUIT INDIA MOVEMENT

Lecture - 01

By – Kunal Sir



Topics *to be covered*

1. Events Leading To Quit India
2. Causes Of Quit India
3. Failure Of Cripps Mission
4. Japanese Threat



Swagat Hai Cheems Gang Ka



Vro Kuch Topics Extra Padhuanga Connect Krne K Liye

Ques Quit India Movement was launched in

(a) 1935

(b) 1945

(c) 1942

(d) 1937

Syllabus.

the Quit India Movement: causes (failure of the Cripps Mission, Japanese threat), Quit India Resolution and the significance of the Movement.


QUIT INDIA MOVEMENT

Quit India Movement

anger / oppose

1. The growing resentment against the British government brought together various groups and classes of Indians into a common struggle for freedom in the first half of the 20th century.

2. This widespread discontent was used by the Congress under the leadership of Mahatma Gandhi into various organised movements for independence.

3. It resulted in a movement calling for complete withdrawal of the British from India or the famous Quit India Movement.

EVENTS LEADING TO QUIT INDIA MOVEMENT

1939

Resignation of the Congress Ministries:

1. The Second World War broke out in September 1939 when Nazi Germany invaded Poland. Britain and France went to Poland's help and declared war on Germany.

2. The British Government of India immediately joined the War without consulting the National Congress or the elected members of the Central Legislature.

3. The Congress leaders asked how it was possible for an enslaved nation to aid others in their fight for freedom.

4. They demanded that India must be declared free or at least have some power before it could actively participate in the War.

EVENTS LEADING TO QUIT INDIA MOVEMENT

Resignation of the Congress Ministries:

1. Lord Linlithgow, the Viceroy, could not give any such assurance.
2. He declared Dominion Status as the goal of British Policy in India.
3. This was considered not sufficient by the Congress.

Self-govt

1. The British government tried to put the religious minorities and Princes against the Congress. The Congress, therefore, asked its ministries to resign.

2. In July 1937, the Congress had formed ministries in the United Provinces, Central Provinces, Orissa, Bihar, Madras and Bombay.

3. Later, Assam and the North-West Frontier also came under the Congress rule.

4. The resignation of the Congress ministries in October-November 1939 had many outcomes

(i) The Viceroy was happy because the Congress ministries had controlled several provinces.

(ii) The ministries in Punjab, Bengal and Sind did not resign to win the government's goodwill.

(iii) The Muslim League was happy over the resignation of Congress Ministries and offered its friendship to the British Government.

(iv) It celebrated the day when the Congress ministries resigned as a 'day of deliverance and 'thanks-giving.'

British Government's reaction to the resignation of Congress Ministers was_____.

(A) Felt relieved as the Congress controlled eight out of the eleven provinces.

(B) Rejected the resignations and reinstated the Congress leadership.

(C) Requested the Muslim League to control the provinces.

(D) Prisoned all the Congress Ministers.

Complete the given analogy

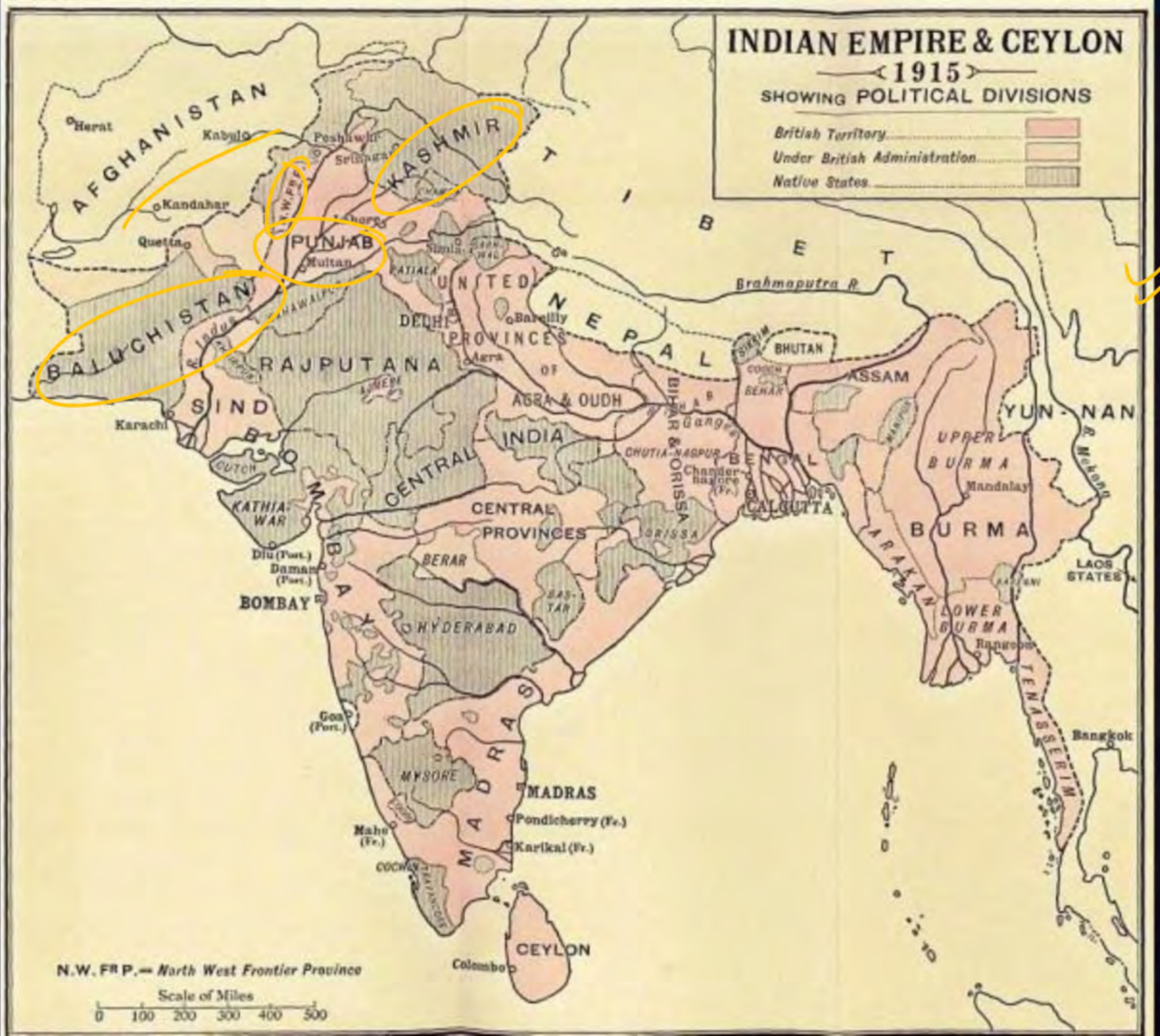
1. A change came in the attitude of the Muslim League and Jinnah after the elections of 1937 – and formation of the Congress Ministries in the Provinces.

2. Jinnah and other leaders of the League proclaimed that Muslims could not expect any justice from the Congress.

3. In 1940, the Muslim League passed a resolution demanding the partition of the country and the creation of a State called Pakistan.

4. The name Pakistan was derived from the letters of the provinces and communities that the new country would comprise: Punjab, Afghan (North-West Frontier Province), Kashmir, Sind and Baluchistan.

5. Jinnah said that the division of India into two autonomous States was the only solution to the Indian problem.


INDIAN EMPIRE & CEYLON
1915
SHOWING POLITICAL DIVISIONS
British Territory
Under British Administration
Native States
AFGHANISTAN
Herat
Kabylo
Kandahar
Quetta
Peshawur
Srinagar
KASHMIR
T I B E T
Brahmaputra R
PUNJAB
Multan
Simla
PATIALA
UNITED PROVINCES OF AGRA & OUDH
Bareilly
Agra
DELHI
NEPAL
BALUCHISTAN
RAJPUTANA
SIND
Karachi
BHUTAN
ASSAM
BIHAR & ORISSA
Ganges R
CHUTIA-NAGPUR
Chandernagore (Fr.)
BENGAL
CALCUTTA
YUN-NAN
UPPER BURMA
Mandalay
Mekong R
BURMA
ARAKAN
LOWER BURMA
Rangoon
LAOS STATES
TENASSERIM
Bangkok
CENTRAL INDIA
CENTRAL PROVINCES
BERAR
HYDERABAD
KATHIAWAR
Diu (Port.)
Daman (Port.)
BOMBAY
Goa (Port.)
MYSORE
MADRAS
Pondicherry (Fr.)
Karikal (Fr.)
Mahe (Fr.)
COCHIN
TRAVANCORE
CEYLON
Colombo
N.W. FR P. — North West Frontier Province
Scale of Miles
0 100 200 300 400 500

August Offer (1940):

- A change of government took place in Britain in May 1940.
- Winston Churchill became Prime Minister and L.S. Amery took over as the Secretary of State for India.
- The War situation in Europe worsened.
- The fall of France and the danger of Nazi occupation of Britain temporarily made Congress soft towards British
- On June 1, 1940, Gandhiji declared: We do not seek our independence out of British ruin.'

1. The international compulsions forced the British Government and the British Indian Government to seek some settlement or understanding with the Congress.

2. On August 8, 1940 (on the eve of the Battle of Britain), Lord Linlithgow, the Viceroy, made a new offer known as the 'August Offer'.

3. The Congress rejected the offer because the minorities especially the Muslim League were assured that no constitutional scheme would be acceptable to the government unless and until it was acepted by the minorities.

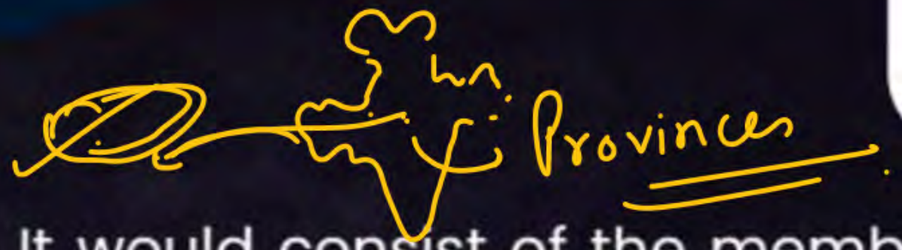
4. The Muslim League did not accept the offer, as it did not give a clear assurance for the establishment of Pakistan.

The Cripps' Mission (1942):

- Since Japanese army was rapidly moving towards India, it became necessary for the British to break the political deadlock in India.
- Churchill announced in March 1942, that Sir Stafford Cripps, a member of the War Cabinet, would go to India for consultation with all the parties. **The Cripps' Mission proposed the following Constitutional reforms:**

1. India would be given a Dominion Status when the War would end. This Dominion would have the freedom to remain with the British Commonwealth or to withdraw from it.

group of 56 independent (countries)



2. A Constituent Assembly would be set up. It would consist of the members elected by the Lower House of the Indian Legislature and the representatives of the Princely States nominated by their rulers. It would be set up to draft a new Constitution.

3. There would be a federation of British India and Indian States. Any province that was not prepared to accept the Constitution would be allowed to obtain Dominion Status separately.

4. The Provinces would be free to join the Indian Union. If they would not join the Indian federation, they would form their own Constitutions which could have the same status as the Union of India.

5. Provisions would also be made for the protection of the racial and religious minorities.

6. During the critical years of the War, the power of the Viceroy would remain as it is and he would be responsible for the defence of the country.

7. But the task of organising the military and material resources of India would be the responsibility of the Government of India with the cooperation of the people of India.

The proposal of Cripps Mission regarding the Princely states:

(A) Any province not willing to join the Union could have a separate constitution and form a separate Union.

(B) Princely states give full protection to religious and racial minorities.

(C) Princely states follow the Divide and Rule policy

(D) Princely states had to be a part of India or Pakistan.

Failure of the Cripps Mission:



Almost all the parties and sections of the people rejected the proposals on the following grounds:

1. The Cripps' Mission did not promise independence in the near future.

2. The plan involved partitioning the country.

3. The League opposed the creation of a single union. The proposals did not accept Pakistan specifically. They did not grant the right of self-rule to Muslims.

4. The Hindu Mahasabha rejected the proposals because it feared the partition of the country.

5. The Sikhs, the Anglo-Indians, the Indian Christians and labour leaders also opposed them because they did not provide sufficient protection for their interests.

6. The people of the Princely States had no right to send their representatives to the proposed Constitution-making body. Their representatives were to be selected by the rulers.

7. The Congress was opposed to the principle of non-accession of the provinces.(meaning -any Indian province that was unwilling to join the new Indian dominion after World War II could choose to form a separate union or have its own separate constitution.)This was against united India

.

Gandhiji opposed the Declaration and urged the Working Committee to reject it. Mahatma Gandhi described the Cripps' proposals as a 'post-dated cheque on a failing bank.'

→ Gandhi → was convinced that British will not fulfill the promise

8. Congress wanted that all Subjects, including Defence should be handed over to the National Government.

9. The Congress insisted on the immediate formation of a National Government with full responsibility

Japanese Threat:

1. The War situation was discouraging in 1942. The Japanese Army had attacked Burma (Myanmar) and was marching towards Assam.
2. Gandhiji observed, 'The presence of British in India is an invitation to Japan to invade India. Their withdrawal removes the bait.'
3. The Indian leaders were anxious to save their country from the Japanese invasion.
4. Gandhiji and other leaders were convinced that this situation called for complete independence from the British immediately.

Japanese Threat:

1. Gandhiji said, 'India's safety, and Britain's too, lies in the orderly and timely British withdrawal from India'.

2. So they decided to launch a movement calling upon the British to quit India.

QUIT INDIA RESOLUTION

1. In 1942, the failure, of the Cripps' Mission left no further meeting ground between the British Government and the Congress.

2. Mahatma Gandhi felt that the British presence in India was an invitation to Japan to invade India .He therefore, asked the British "to leave India in God's hands."

3. The Congress Working Committee met at Wardha in July, 1942.

4. It adopted a resolution, known as the Quit India Resolution. The resolution stated: 'British rule in India must end immediately.'

QUIT INDIA MOVEMENT

Gowalia Tank Maidan.

1. The All-India Congress Committee met at Bombay on August 8, 1942 and passed the Quit India Resolution adopted at Wardha in July 1942.

2. The Congress proposed to start a non-violent mass struggle under Gandhiji's leadership if this demand of immediate and complete independence was not conceded by the British.

3. In his speech before the All India Congress Committee, Gandhiji declared that it was a decision "To Do or Die".

Quit India Resolution stated:

(A) India is joining the British in the Second World War.

(B) British Rule in India must end immediately.

(C) India will be partitioned into 2 nations.

(D) British to leave India in God's hands.



Summary

(15 points)

1. Failure of Cripps.
2. Japanese Threat
3. Significance
4. Resolution → 4 points

Study This



Homework From VICTORY Module

With respect to Quit India

(a) Three Reasons for failure of Cripps Mission (3)

(b) Discuss Japanese threat (3)

(c) Discuss Significance of Quit India (4)


Thank You